

GRAMMAR

UNIT 1

Simple Present

FORM

+	I, you, we, they He, she, it		like likes	milk.
-	I, you, we, they He, she, it	do not does not	like	
?	Do Does	I, you, we, they he, she, it	like	milk?

SPELLING RULES

For the 3rd person singular (he, she, it)

We add **s** to the main verb

work+s = he works

Exceptions

We add **es** in verbs ending in **sh, ch, ss, o, x**

wash + es = he washes

We add **ies** in verbs ending in **consonant + y**

study + ies = he studies

Examples of **vowels**: a, e, o, i, u

Examples of **consonants**: b, c, d, f, g, etc.

USE

We use the Simple Present tense when:

- something happens regularly
- something is true in general

We use an **ADVERB OF FREQUENCY** like ***always, usually, often, sometimes*** to say how often something happens.

It comes ***before*** the verb in the Present Simple.

When we have the verb 'to be' we put the adverb ***after*** it.

E.g. *We always have maths on Monday.*

Do you often play football at school?

My brother is always early for school.

EXAMPLES

I live in Patras.

The Moon goes round the Earth.

John's father drives a taxi. He does not drive a bus.

My sister and I do not watch TV after 10.00 at night.

Do you always play football on Saturdays?

Wh... questions / How ... questions with Simple Present

EXAMPLES

What	do you / they	have	for breakfast?
What time		go	to school?
Where		spend	holidays?
When		come home	from school?
Who	does he / she / it	play	tennis with?
How often		meet	friends?

Present Continuous

FORM

+	I am		speaking	to you.
	You are		reading	this.
-	She is	not	staying	in London.
	We are		playing	football.
?	Is he		watching	TV?
	Are they		waiting	for John?

SPELLING RULES

We add **-ing** to the main verb: work + ing = working

Exceptions

a. If the main verb ends in **consonant + stressed vowel + consonant**, we double the last letter: stop + p + ing = **stopping** / cut + t + ing = **cutting**

b. If the main verb ends in **ie**, we change the **ie** to **y**: die = diey + ing = **dying**

c. If the main verb ends in **vowel + consonant + e**, omit the **e**: come + ing = **coming**

USE

We use the Present Continuous tense to talk about:

- an action happening exactly now
- an action happening around now

EXAMPLES

Look! The bus is coming!

Are you learning French or English?

We are not having breakfast at the moment.

Simple Past

FORM

+	I			worked	very hard.
	You			went	to school.
-	He / She	did	not	go	with me.
	We			work	yesterday.
?	Did	you		go	to London?
		they		work	at home?

USE

We use the Simple Past tense to talk about an action, a situation or an event, short or long, that

- happened in the past
- is completely finished
- we say (or understand) the time and/or place it happened

EXAMPLES

I lived in that house when I was younger.

He didn't like the movie.

What did you eat for dinner?

John rode his bike to school on Monday.

Mary did not go to school yesterday.

PAY ATTENTION TO THE IRREGULAR VERBS

UNIT 3

Comparisons of adjectives and adverbs

FORM

	POSITIVE	COMPARATIVE	SUPERLATIVE
SHORT ADJECTIVES	strong big ugly	... -er than	the ... -est of/in
		stronger than bigger than uglier than	the strongest of/in the biggest of/in the ugliest of/in
LONG ADJECTIVES	horrible	more ... than	the most ... of/in
		more horrible than	the most horrible of/in

USE

In the Comparative form we add -er than in short adjectives and more + adjective + than in long adjectives.

In the Superlative form we add the -est in short adjectives and the most + adjective in long adjectives.

Irregular adjectives

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
good	better than	the best of/in
bad	worse than	the worst of/in
far	farther/further than	the farthest/furthest of/in
much/many	more than	the most of/in
little	less than	the least of/in

Comparisons of adjectives with *as ... as* and *not so ... as*

EXAMPLES

The night is as dark as hell.

noun or pronoun	positive verb	as	adjective	as	noun or pronoun
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Our house is not as / so luxurious as a hotel.

noun or pronoun	negative verb	as / so	adjective	as	noun or pronoun
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GRAMMAR

Adverbs

FORM

To form a regular adverb we add *-ly* / *-ily* to an adjective

ADJECTIVE	ADVERB
quiet	quietly
happy	happily
EXCEPTIONS	
fast	fast
hard	hard
good	well

EXAMPLES

The children are quiet. They are playing quietly.

That is a happy boy. He is singing happily.

That is a fast horse. It runs fast.

This exercise is hard. Tom is working hard on this exercise.

Jim is a good football player. He plays football well.

USE

We use adverbs when we want to answer the question **HOW**.

	ADVERB	COMPARATIVE	SUPERLATIVE
SHORT ADVERBS	soon early	sooner earlier	the soonest the earliest
LONG ADVERBS	carefully	more carefully	the most carefully

	ADVERB	COMPARATIVE	SUPERLATIVE
IRREGULAR FORMS	well badly little many / much	better worse less more	the best the worst the least the most

UNIT 4

Modal verbs: can, may, should

FORM

+	I you he	can may should	ride	this bike.
-	she we they	cannot / can't may not should not / shouldn't	ride	this bike.
?	Can May Should	I / you he / she we / they	ride	this bike?

USE

CAN: Possibility / Ability

We use CAN to talk about what is possible or what we are able or free to do:

Examples

She *can* fly a plane.

John *can* speak Spanish.

I *cannot* hear you. (I *can't* hear you.)

Can you hear me?

CAN, MAY: Permission

We sometimes use CAN to ask or give permission for something:

Examples

Can I leave early today?

May I leave early today?

The use of CAN for permission is informal.

SHOULD: Advice

We sometimes use SHOULD to give advice to someone:

Examples

You *should* be brave and well trained if you want to be a lifeguard.

GRAMMAR

Simple Future

FORM

+	I	will		open	the door.
	You			finish	before me.
-	We	will	not	be	at school tomorrow.
	She			leave	yet.
?	Will	you they		arrive	on time?
				want	dinner?

For negative sentences in the **Simple Future tense**, we contract with **won't**, like this:

I will not	I won't
you will not	you won't
he/she/it will not	he/she/it won't
we will not	we won't
they will not	they won't

USE

We use the **Simple Future tense** to show **prediction, offer, promise, warning, decision on the spot and request**.

EXAMPLES

It **will rain** tomorrow. (prediction)

I **ll bring** it right away! (offer)

I **ll fix** your car tomorrow. (promise)

If you don't follow my advice, you **won't get** well. (warning)

Will you bring a bottle of water? (request)

There is no bread left. I **ll go** and buy some! (decision on the spot)

Note that when we have a plan or intention to do something in the future, we usually use other tenses or expressions, such as the **Present Continuous tense** or **be going to**.

UNIT 5

Present Perfect Simple

FORM

	subject	auxiliary verb	main verb	
+	I / You / We / They	have	played	football.
	He / She	has	visited	Rome.
-	I / You / We / They	haven't	won	the 200 m. race.
	He / She	hasn't	seen	ET.
?	Have	you / we / they	finished?	
	Has	he / she	done	it?

USE

We use the **Present Perfect Simple tense** to talk about **past activities**, which we are not interested in **when** they happened. We only want to know **if they happened**.

EXAMPLES

I **have seen** ET.

He **has lived** in Paris.

Have you **visited** Rome?

They **have never broken** a world record.

NOTE: If we are interested in When an action happened we use **Simple Past tense**.

Example: Ian Thorpe **won** the 400 m freestyle in 2004 Athens Olympics.

Conditional Sentences

FORM

	IF-clause	Result clause
Type 1	Simple Present tense	will, can, must, + bare infinitive or imperative
Type 2	Simple Past tense	would + bare infinitive

USE

We use **Type 1 Conditional Sentences** to show that **something is possible to happen in the present or future**.

We use **Type 2 Conditional Sentences** to show that **something is very unlikely to happen in the present or future**.

This kind of sentences **often expresses a wish or advice**.

EXAMPLES

Type 1

If you choose to attend this excellent musical, you will learn the importance of personal safety, proper diet, and good health.

If you like Greek folk music, register for this event.

If you want to learn about other cultures, you can attend the dances from Peru.

Type 2

If I won a lot of money, I would (I'd) buy a lot of CD's.

If I were you, I'd pay back all the money I owe.

NOTE: When we use **Type 2 Conditional** we prefer to use **were** instead of **was**.

UNIT 7

Past Continuous

FORM

+	I / he / she	was		watching	TV.
	You	were		working	hard.
-	I / he / she	was	not	helping	Mary.
	We	were		joking.	
?	Was	he / she		studying	Maths?
	Were	you / they		playing	football?

USE

The **Past Continuous tense** expresses an action that happened at a particular moment in the past and it continued for some time.

EXAMPLES

*I was doing my homework at 6.00 in the evening.
 They were not playing football at 9am this morning.
 What were you doing at 10pm last night?
 Tony went home early because it was snowing.*

Past Continuous + Simple Past

USE

We often use the **Past Continuous tense** with the **Simple Past tense**. We use the **Past Continuous tense** to express a **long** action. And we use the **Simple Past tense** to express a **short** action that happens **in the middle** of the long action. We can join the two ideas with **when** or **while**.

We use:

- **when** + **short action** (Simple Past tense)
- **while** + **long action** (Past Continuous tense)

EXAMPLES

	<i>I was watching TV</i>	<i>when</i>	<i>the telephone rang.</i>
<i>When</i>	<i>the telephone rang</i>		<i>I was watching TV.</i>
	<i>The telephone rang</i>	<i>while</i>	<i>I was watching TV.</i>
<i>While</i>	<i>I was watching TV</i>		<i>the telephone rang.</i>



GRAMMAR

Used to...

FORM

In Ancient Greece, people	used to	wear	linen clothes in summer.
When I was fifteen I		listen to	rock music.

USE

We use **used to + infinitive** to talk about a past state that is not true now or about an old habit that has now stopped.

REMEMBER

We can use either **used to...** or **Past Simple** to talk about a past state or habit that is no longer true, but we can only use **Past Simple** to talk about things we did at a specific time in the past.

Asking for and giving directions / information

When we ask for directions / information we use the following	When we give directions / information we use the following
Excuse me, how can I go/ get to... Can/could you tell me where... is, please? Can/Could you show me the way to...? What time...? How much..., please?	Go up/down... street until you get to... Go straight... Take the bus/ train to... Turn right/left... It's on the corner of... Take the first/second turning... It is near/opposite/behind/in front of/ between...

UNIT 8

Tag Questions; Relative Pronouns

FORM

+	-
Positive statement,	negative tag?
Snow is white,	<i>isn't it?</i>
-	+
Negative statement,	positive tag?
You don't like me,	<i>do you?</i>

Some special cases:

I am right, aren't I?	aren't I (<i>not amn't</i> I)
You have to go, don't you?	you (do) have to go...

USE

A **tag question** is a statement followed by a mini-question. The whole sentence is a "tag question", and the mini-question at the end is called a "question tag".

We use **tag questions** at the end of statements to ask for confirmation. They mean something like: "Am I right?" or "Do you agree?" They are very common in English.

EXAMPLES

You have a sister, don't you?

You don't know the answer, do you?

He went to India last year, didn't he?

You can play tennis, can't you?

GRAMMAR

Relative Pronouns

FORM

relative pronoun	use		example
who	subject or object pronoun for people		I told you about the girl <i>who</i> lives next door.
which	subject or object pronoun for animals and things		Do you see the dog <i>which</i> is lying in the garden?
which	referring to a whole sentence		He couldn't swim <i>which</i> surprised me.
whose	possession for people animals and things		Do you know the boy <i>whose</i> mother is a teacher?
that	subject or object pronoun for people, animals and things in defining relative clauses (<i>who</i> or <i>which</i> are also possible)		I like the dress <i>that</i> Anna is wearing.
relative adverb	meaning	use	example
when	in/on which	refers to a time expression	the day <i>when</i> we met him
where	in/at which	refers to a place	the place <i>where</i> we met him
why	for which	refers to a reason	the reason <i>why</i> we met him

USE

We use **relative clauses** to give additional information about something without starting another sentence.

EXAMPLES

The boys lived in a house *which* was next to the sea.

I don't care *where* she lives.

The thing *that* annoys her is his laziness.

UNIT 9

Wish + Past

FORM

When we want to express a desire for something to happen or to exist, we use the verb *wish* + a past simple form of a verb.

USE

We use *wish* + past simple to express that we want a situation in the present (or future) to be different.

EXAMPLES

I wish I spoke Italian. (I don't speak Italian)

Wish + Would

We use *wish* + *sb or sth* + *would* + *bare infinitive* to express impatience, annoyance or dissatisfaction with a present action or situation.

EXAMPLES

I wish it would stop raining

I wish the children would stop making so much noise

Passive Voice - Simple Present Tense

FORM

We form the **Simple Present Passive** with verb **to be** in the right form and the **Past participle** of the main verb.

Simple Present of verb 'to be'	past participle of main verb
↓	↓
am is are	used/ washed/ finished/ written/ done etc.

USE

We use the **Passive Voice** when we are more interested in the action than in who is responsible for it (agent). When we want to mention who does the action the word **by** comes before it. We also use **Passive Voice** in notices and signs.

EXAMPLES

The young Bond is presented as a tall and scruffy teenager.

The young Bond books are written by Charlie Higson.

Smoking is forbidden.

Tickets are sold out.